

CDN Incident Alert: 0060. TLP: CLEAR		Date
Title	PL Zgorzelec Protest as a Vector for Coordinated Disinformation: Unpacking Russia-Linked Influence Operations in Poland	08/05/2025

Summary

- On March 22, a nationalist-led protest against immigration policies took place at the Polish-German border in Zgorzelec. The event has led to the discovery of a related petition page, which revealed further links to amplifiers, including Newser.pl (an impersonation of Newser.com), and other petition pages connected to Russian sponsors (such as Ordo Luris. One of the petition pages urges Bild to apologise for affiliating the Protests to Neo-Nazis, the other, created by Ordo Luris urges the return of children seized due to neglect by Swedish authorities from a Polish couple living in Sweden.
- The overarching narrative framed Germany and the EU as conducting a "hybrid war" against Poland by forcing migration flows while delegitimizing the Polish state and amplifying existing conflict lines.
- The Zgorzelec-related petition amassed 1,428 signatures and 23,531 signatures in another petition amplified by Newser.pl. Another protest will happen on 10/05.
- The operation sought to Degrade their Adversaries. Tactics employed included Prepare Assets Impersonating Legitimate Entities and Cross-Posting content.
- Continue monitoring the suspicious website and inquiries into the financial statements of the involved individuals. Invest in public awareness campaigns to build resilience against hybrid war narratives.

Incident

On March 22, 2025, a nationalist [protest against immigration](#) took place at the Polish-German border in Zgorzelec, organized by Robert Bąkiewicz, the former president of the Independence March Association (2017–2023) and current president of the Independence party. [Violence broke out during the event, perpetrated by a neo-Nazi group](#), and was [reported on](#) by the German outlet *Bild*. In response, disinformation campaign claiming the violence was staged by [German](#) or state actors was spread by amplification channels [such as Newser.pl](#), a platform impersonating the legitimate news aggregator [Newser.com](#). A petition hosted on [podpizapfel.org](#) was launched to delegitimize *Bild*, [further amplified by Newser.pl](#). Investigations revealed that Newser.pl [also promoted other petitions](#) linked to [Ordo Luris](#), an organization [with established ties](#) to Russian funding networks.

Narrative

Meta-narrative: Poland is besieged and under coordinated attack by Germany, the European Union, and “globalist” elites who use migration as a weapon to undermine Polish sovereignty, identity, and stability.

Sub narratives: defence of ethno-religious identity, delegitimization of the Polish state, delegitimization of critical media, normalization of extremism and Kremlin narratives.

Impact

Reach: 24959 signatures total on the petitions in question.

Outcome: Follow-up anti-immigration protests scheduled by Bąkiewicz on 5 April 2025 in Gubin, as well as 26 April 2025 in Warsaw. Another will happen on the 10th of [May](#). The incident and associated disinformation efforts risk polarizing public opinion, undermining trust in Polish democratic institutions, amplifying nationalist and anti-EU sentiment, and introducing foreign-influenced narratives into the domestic electoral discourse, thereby increasing the vulnerability of the political ecosystem to manipulation.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework) (Max 2 objectives and 4 TTPs).

Objective: [T0066 "Degrade Adversary"](#) – The operation tries to discredit the Polish government and the EU.

Objective: [T0079 "Divide"](#)– The operation tries dividing Polish voters and encourage polarization.

- [T0099 "Prepare Assets Impersonating Legitimate Entities"](#)- Newser.pl impersonates Newser.com, which is a legitimate news aggregator, borrowing legitimacy in order to spread the petition pages, as well as disinformation about the protest in Zgorzelec.

- [T0119 "Cross-Posting"](#)- The Russia-backed petition pages have been advertised with Newser.pl, and further aggregated on X.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Recommendations: Strengthening of monitoring of suspicious media outlets and petition platforms, including inquiries into financial statements of the involved individuals; invest in public awareness campaigns to build resilience against hybrid war narratives;

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
Upon Request	Russia	In text	Maria Voltsichina, Debunk.org	X, Petition Platforms.	